



Index Number:

NATIONAL CERTIFICATE OF EDUCATION

2025

ENGLISH (N500)

TIME: 2 HOURS 15 MINUTES

Candidates answer on the Question Paper.

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Write your index number in the space provided above.
2. Write in dark blue or black ink. Do not use correction fluid.
3. Any rough working should be done in this booklet.
4. Answer **ALL** questions.
5. For Question 10, answer either Option A or Option B.
6. This document consists of **10** questions printed on **21** pages, numbered **2** to **22**.
7. The number of marks for each question is given in brackets ().
8. The total mark for this paper is **100**.

For Examiners' use												
Question No.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	Total	Signature
Examiner												
Team Leader												
CE/ACE												

Question 1 (15 marks)

For items 1 to 6, circle the correct letter. Each item carries one mark.

1. They went the beach during the weekend.

- A** with
- B** to
- C** for
- D** into

2. The chair is old. legs are shaky.

- A** Her
- B** His
- C** Its
- D** Their

3. I love mangoes. I eat them as dessert.

- A** often
- B** never
- C** rarely
- D** hardly

4. Jeremy is than Mary.

- A** as kind
- B** so kind
- C** kinder
- D** kindest

5. day, I brush my teeth twice.

- A Some
- B All
- C Any
- D Every

6. When he was born, his eyes light brown.

- A is
- B were
- C was
- D are

For each of items 7 to 9, circle the letter showing the correct sentence. Each item carries one mark.

7. **A** While mum prepares dinner, Mary was reading her book.
B While mum prepared dinner, Mary reads her book.
C While mum is preparing dinner, Mary had read her book.
D While mum was preparing dinner, Mary was reading her book.

8. **A** If you wake up early, you will have time to revise.
B If you woke up early, you will have time to revise.
C If you had woken up early, you will have time to revise.
D If you have woken up early, you will have time to revise.

9. **A** How does this road lead to?
B Which does this road lead to?
C Where does this road lead to?
D Why does this road lead to?

For items 10 to 15, follow the instructions given. Each item carries one mark.

10. **Underline the words which should begin with a capital letter.**

john is going to spain next month.

11. **Re-write the following sentence using 'neighbour' in the plural.**

My neighbour's cat is very pretty.

.....

.....

12. **Re-write the sentence below in its negative form.**

Pam watered the plants last Sunday.

.....

.....

13. **Use the word in brackets to link the following sentences. Remember to make all necessary changes.**

Paul will go running. It rains. (unless)

.....

.....

14. **Re-write the sentence below using indirect speech.**

The shopkeeper told Jim, "Throw the box away."

.....

.....

15. **Re-write the sentence below using active voice.**

A new car was bought by Salim.

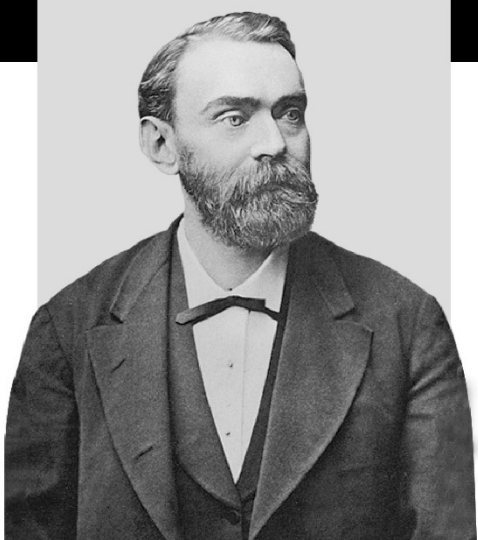
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Question 3 (10 marks)

Read the text below and answer the questions that follow.

A black and white portrait of Alfred Nobel, a man with a full beard and mustache, wearing a suit and bow tie.

Key events in the life of
Alfred Nobel
Born : 21 October 1833
Died : 10 December 1896
Known for : inventing dynamite
Professions : chemist, inventor, engineer, businessman
Testament¹ : 3 million dollars to fund the Nobel prizes

Alfred Nobel's main invention: The dynamite

Alfred found that mixing nitroglycerine with a fine sand called *kieselguhr* would turn the liquid into paste. This could be shaped into rods that could then be inserted into drilling holes. Alfred named his invention, made in 1866, "dynamite." This invention helped reduce the cost of many construction projects such as drilling tunnels and building bridges.

Nobel Prizes

Alfred spent the last five years of his life in San Remo, Italy. In his last will, he wrote that much of his fortune was to be used to award the Nobel Prizes. The aim of these prizes was to reward those who have done their best for humanity.

Nobel prizes are awarded in the fields of Physics, Chemistry, Physiology or Medicine, literature and peace. The Peace Prize is awarded to the person who accomplished "the most or the best work for fraternity among nations." In 2014, Malala Yousafzai was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize for her fight for the right of every child to receive an education.

¹*Testament: A document that says how one's money and property should be used after one's death.*

1. In which year was Alfred Nobel born?
..... [1]
2. Name one of Alfred Nobel's professions.
..... [1]
3. How much money did Alfred Nobel leave in his testament?
..... [1]
4. What is *kieselguhr*?
..... [1]
5. In which year was the dynamite invented?
..... [1]
6. What is the benefit of using dynamites in construction projects?
..... [1]
7. How long did Alfred Nobel spend in San Remo before dying?
..... [1]
8. What is the aim of the Nobel Prizes?
..... [1]
9. (i) Who won the Nobel Peace Prize in 2014?
..... [1]
- (ii) Why was the person awarded this prize?
..... [1]

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Question 4 (5 marks)

Write the correct form of the words in brackets. The first one has been done for you.

Anne of Green Gables is a novel for **children** (**child**). It (**tell**)

the story of Anne Shirley, an orphan. Anne is (**mischief**) by nature.

She also has a lot of (**imagine**). When she is eleven, Anne is

..... (**adopt**) by Marilla and Matthew Cuthbert. She

(**gradual**) transforms their lives, making Marilla and Matthew very happy.

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Question 5 (5 marks)

Read the text below and correct the underlined mistakes. The first one has been done for you.

Breadfruit is a large green fruits from the breadfruit tree. It is a staple food in many
.....
fruit

tropical area. The breadfruit is rich of Vitamin C. Its also an excellent source of fibre.

Since their is starch in breadfruit, it replaces rice and potatoes in many cuisines.

Some people fry it while others choose to boiled it.

Question 6 (5 marks)

Complete the following text by writing one suitable word in each blank space. The first one has been done for you.

Routine tasks such as washing the dishes, sweeping the floor or folding the laundry are called chores. There are benefits to including chores in children's daily lives. Chores children to become more responsible. Children learn to their anger and other negative emotions. Doing household chores teaches children discipline. These skills can lead to greater success their lives.

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Question 7 (10 marks)

You have lost your cat. Write a short note that you will place on a notice board to ask for help with finding your cat.

Write about 50-75 words based on the following:

- What does the cat look like?
- Where was the cat last seen?
- How do you feel about losing your cat?
- What reward will you offer to the person who finds your cat?
- How can you be contacted?

Dear friends,

.....

.....

.....

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.....

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.....

.....

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.....

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.....

.....

Yours,

.....

Question 8 (20 marks)

Read the passage below and answer the questions which follow.

The following passage recounts how the narrator's friend, Sophie, told her stories about famous places in the world when she was young.

- 1 When I was eleven, my family and I moved to a new neighbourhood. My new home was a 5-minute brisk walk to an outdoor playground. Although I adored playing on the slides, seesaws and swings, my **favourite** spot became the faded green metal bench, my time-and-place travel capsule.
- 2 On my second visit to the playground, after having played for an hour on the seesaw, I sat on the old bench to eat my lunch. As always, that Saturday, the lunch box was multi-textured and multi-coloured: two crisp green apples, five firm orange pawpaw cubes and two soft red strawberries. I offered one apple to the young girl sitting quietly on the far side of the bench, perusing a photo album. She told me her name was Sophie. My usual curious eyes caught a glimpse of an unexpected sight. Pointing my chubby finger at her album, I asked her, "What's happened to this tower?" Her eyes lit up, she smiled and took me to Pisa, a town in Italy, where there is a famous tower that is not quite upright. The tower, which had been built a long time ago, was supposed to be straight but with the unstable soil, had ended up in a bent position. "It's called the Leaning Tower of Pisa!" she said. 5 10
- 3 The following Saturday, as soon as I reached the playground, I looked at the bench. There she was! On display that day was the picture of a triangular-looking object. "Why would anyone build this huge triangle?" I asked, puzzled. That day, we went on an adventure to the great pyramids of Egypt. "No one knows for sure what these pyramids are for. Maybe they are the giant tombs that hold a pharaoh's remains, maybe they are something else. These pyramids remain a mystery." From then onwards, every Saturday, she took me on trips to different **corners** of the globe. 15 20
- 4 Then, one day, my heart sank - there was nothing on her lap. "Good morning! Rainy day, today! Shall we go somewhere dry and warm?" she asked me. I reached out for her slender hand. Off we went... down the playground lane, up the main road, into the village hall yard, until finally we reached the village library. As I went through the heavy door she was holding for me, I beamed: shelves full of books, corridors full of shelves and two floors of the building full of corridors! An extraordinary treasure trove! 25
- 5 Sophie collected her badge, which she clipped on her jumper. On it, in bold print, was written 'Books for Fun'. "Shall we sign you up to the library then?" Sophie **queried**. The look on my face said it all. She walked us towards the children's section and helped me fill in an enrolment form. We then made our way to the nearest shelving unit. She gave my hand a gentle squeeze before slowly letting it go, "The choice is all yours!" 30
- 6 My eyes scanned all the colourful books, neatly lined up on the shelves, until I saw a turquoise book. I pulled it out. On the cover was the picture of the blue-green sea, friendly fish, playful dolphins and shimmering coral reefs, with the words "Under the sea". That winter, I spent the rest of my Saturday mornings making the most of my library subscription. In total, I read twenty-nine books at the library and took out dozens more to read at home during the week. It was the time of all adventures. 35

From Paragraph 1

1. Pick out the word which shows that the green bench had lost some of its colour.

..... [1]

From Paragraph 2

2. What did the narrator do before she had her lunch?

..... [1]

3. The narrator offered an apple to Sophie. What does this show about the narrator's character?

..... [1]

4. How do we know that Sophie was happy to be answering the narrator's questions? Give **two** pieces of evidence.

(i).....

(ii).....

[2]

5. Why is the tower of Pisa "not quite upright" (line 12)?

..... [1]

From Paragraph 3

6. According to you, why did the narrator look at the bench as soon as she reached the playground?

..... [1]

7. What is the "huge triangle" the narrator referred to (line 17)?

..... [1]

From Paragraph 4

8. Pick out the expression which shows that the narrator was disappointed.

..... [1]

9. Why was there no book on Sophie's lap that day?

..... [1]

10. (i) How did the narrator feel about going into the village library?

..... [1]

- (ii) How do you know?

..... [1]

From Paragraph 5

11. "The look on my face said it all" (lines 29-30).

According to you, what did the look on the narrator's face tell Sophie?

..... [1]

12. Sophie squeezed the narrator's hand before letting it go. What does this show about Sophie's feelings for the narrator?

..... [1]

From Paragraph 6

13. Which word tells us that the narrator took great care before choosing a book?

..... [1]

From the entire passage

14. Explain fully why the narrator describes the bench as the "time-and-place travel capsule" (lines 3-4).

..... [2]

15. Give the meaning of the following words or expressions as they have been used in the passage.

- (i) favourite (para 1)

A most feared

C most trusted

B most liked

D most disappointing

- (ii) corners (para 3)

A quarters

C spaces

B pieces

D parts

- (iii) queried (para 5)

A said

C asked

B told

D shouted

[3]

Question 9 (15 marks)

Write an essay of about 200-250 words on one of the following:

(i) Descriptive writing

Describe the scene at lunchtime in your school.

(Remember you must describe what you can see, hear and smell, and what you feel.)

Or

(ii) Argumentative writing

When there is no school because of a heavy rain warning, classes should be held online. Do you agree?

Or

(iii) Narrative writing

Write a story that includes the following line:

“We had a feeling that we were now lost...”

Option chosen:

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Question 10 (10 marks) - Answer either Option A or Option B**Option A - Poetry (10 marks)**

Read the poem below and answer the questions that follow.

Still I Rise

You may write me down in history
With your bitter, twisted lies,
You may trod me in the very dirt
But still, like dust, I'll rise.

Just like moons and like suns,
With the certainty of tides,
Just like hopes springing high,
Still I'll rise.

Did you want to see me broken?
Bowed head and lowered eyes?
Shoulders falling down like teardrops,
Weakened by my soulful cries?

You may shoot me with your words,
You may cut me with your eyes,
You may kill me with your hatefulness,
But still, like air, I'll rise.

Adapted from *Still I Rise*, by Maya Angelou

1. (i) Which **narrative voice** is the poet using in this poem?

- A** First-person
- B** Second-person
- C** Third-person
- D** Fourth-person

[1]

(ii) Find one piece of evidence to support your answer.

..... [1]

2. Which one of the following is a pair of **rhyming words**?

- A** lies, dirt
- B** suns, tides
- C** eyes, cries
- D** broken, words

[1]

3. (i) Which one of the following is a **simile**?

- A** You may write me down in history
- B** With the certainty of tides
- C** Did you want to see me broken?
- D** But still, like air, I'll rise

[1]

(ii) What is the effect of using a simile here?

..... [1]

4. What do you understand by the following lines from the poem?

- (i) "You may write me down in history
With your bitter, twisted lies,..."

.....
..... [1]

- (ii) "You may shoot me with your words,..."

.....
..... [1]

5. According to you, what is this poem about?

Support your answer with close reference to the poem.

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[3]

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Option B - Prose (10 marks)

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow.

In the extract below, a poor couple, Kino and Juana, desperately try to get treatment for their baby who has been stung by a scorpion.

The screams of the baby brought the neighbours, who came running and crowded in the door, trying to look in. And those in front passed the word back – “Scorpion. The baby has been stung.”

Juana stopped sucking the puncture for a moment to look at the wound. All these people knew about the scorpion. An adult might be very ill from the sting, but a baby could easily die from the poison. 5

“The doctor,” she said. “Go to get the doctor.”

A remarkable thing was to want a doctor who never came to their cluster of huts.

“He would not come,” Kino told Juana. She looked up. Her eyes were as cold as the eyes of a lioness. This was her first baby - nearly everything in her world. 10

“Then we will go to him,” Juana said, and wrapped the moaning baby in her blue shawl. The neighbours followed them. The thing had become a neighbourhood affair. As they passed by the church, the beggars sitting there quickly looked at Juana and Kino’s clothes, and guessed they were poor.

Kino hesitated at the doctor’s gate, knowing this man was not of his people and would treat them like animals. As he removed his hat, and began to knock at the door, rage swelled in him. 15

When Kino spoke in the old language about his poisoned child, the servant refused to listen and closed the gate. In his chamber, the doctor sat in a red silk dressing-gown. He angrily rejected the request. 20

“Have I nothing better to do than cure insect bites for those people? I am a doctor, not a veterinary. Has he got any money?” the doctor demanded.

At the gate, the servant asked, “Do you have money to pay for the treatment?” Kino showed eight misshapen seed pearls as ugly and grey as little ulcers, almost valueless. The servant took the paper and shortly returned to say the doctor was out. 25

The whole procession melted away so that they would not directly witness the public shaming of Kino. For a long time, Kino stood in front of the gate with Juana beside him. Frustrated, he struck the gate, splitting his knuckles and watching blood flow between his fingers.

Adapted from *The Pearl*, by John Steinbeck

1. (i) Which **narrative voice** is the narrator using in this extract?
- A** First-person
- B** Second-person
- C** Third-person
- D** Fourth-person
- [1]
- (ii) Find one piece of evidence in the text to support your answer.
-
- [1]
2. (i) Which one of the following is a **simile**?
- A** All these people knew about the scorpion.
- B** The screams of the baby brought the neighbours.
- C** Her eyes were as cold as the eyes of a lioness.
- D** Kino hesitated at the doctor's gate.
- [1]
- (ii) What is the effect of using a simile here?
-
- [1]
3. What do you understand by the following lines from the extract?
- (i) "This was her first baby - nearly everything in her world." (line 10)
-
- [1]
- (ii) "The thing had become a neighbourhood affair." (line 12)
-
- [1]

- (iii) “The whole procession melted away.” (line 26)

.....

..... [1]

4. Based on your reading of the extract, describe the doctor’s character.
Support your answer with close reference to the extract.

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..... [3]

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